Greenfield Community Clinic
Patient Handbook

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.
The clinic, its staff and its policies are fictional. In an emergency in Bangladesh, call 999.

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Allergies

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Seasonal allergies and hay fever [kb:allergies:1]

Allergic rhinitis, often called hay fever, causes sneezing, an itchy or runny nose and itchy, watery eyes. It is triggered by things like pollen, dust mites, mould or animal dander. Unlike a cold, it does not cause fever and can last for weeks while the trigger is around.

Reducing allergy triggers [kb:allergies:2]

Keep windows closed on high-pollen days, wash bedding in hot water each week, reduce dust, shower and change clothes after being outdoors, and keep pets out of the bedroom if they trigger symptoms.

Allergy medicines from the pharmacy [kb:allergies:3]

Antihistamine tablets, nasal sprays and eye drops are available from pharmacies. Some antihistamines cause drowsiness, so read the label before driving. Ask a pharmacist which product suits you, especially for children, during pregnancy or if you take other medicines.

Severe allergic reactions [kb:allergies:4]

A severe allergic reaction, called anaphylaxis, can happen within minutes of a food, insect sting or medicine. Signs include swelling of the lips, tongue or throat, difficulty breathing, wheezing, feeling faint or collapsing. This is an emergency: call 999 straight away and use an adrenaline auto-injector if one has been prescribed.

Antibiotics

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What antibiotics treat [kb:antibiotics:1]

Antibiotics treat infections caused by bacteria. They do not work against viruses, so they do not help colds, flu, most sore throats or most coughs. A clinician decides whether an antibiotic is needed.

Taking antibiotics as prescribed [kb:antibiotics:2]

Take an antibiotic exactly as your clinician or pharmacist explains, for as long as you were told, even if you start to feel better. Never share antibiotics, use leftovers from an earlier illness, or buy them without a prescription.

Antibiotic resistance [kb:antibiotics:3]

Using antibiotics when they are not needed helps bacteria become resistant, which means the medicines stop working when people really need them. Using them only when prescribed protects you and your community.

Side effects and antibiotic allergy [kb:antibiotics:4]

Common side effects include an upset stomach and diarrhoea. Tell the clinic about any rash or reaction. Swelling of the face or throat, or difficulty breathing after a dose, is an emergency. Always tell clinicians and pharmacists if you have ever had an allergy to an antibiotic.

Appointments

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Booking an appointment [kb:appointments:1]

Book an appointment at the front desk, by calling the number on your clinic card, or through the patient portal. Routine appointments are usually available within a week. Same-day appointments are kept for problems that should not wait.

What to bring to an appointment [kb:appointments:2]

Bring your clinic card, a photo ID, your medicine list or the medicine boxes themselves, any home readings such as blood pressure or blood sugar, and your child's vaccination card for child visits. Write down your questions before you come.

Cancelling or arriving late [kb:appointments:3]

If you cannot attend, please cancel at least 24 hours before so the slot can go to someone else. If you arrive more than 15 minutes late, you may be asked to rebook, unless the problem is urgent.

Walk-in visits [kb:appointments:4]

A limited number of walk-in slots are available each morning from 8:00 am for urgent problems. Patients are seen in order of medical need, not arrival time, so waiting times can vary.

Asthma

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What asthma is [kb:asthma:1]

Asthma is a long-term condition in which the airways become swollen and narrow, causing wheezing, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath. Symptoms often come and go and can be worse at night or with exercise. With good care most people with asthma live normal, active lives.

Common asthma triggers [kb:asthma:2]

Common triggers include colds and flu, dust and dust mites, smoke from tobacco or cooking fires, air pollution, pollen, pets, cold air, strong smells and exercise. Knowing your triggers and avoiding them where possible helps keep asthma under control.

Reliever and preventer inhalers [kb:asthma:3]

A reliever inhaler works quickly to open the airways during symptoms. A preventer inhaler is used every day, even when you feel well, to reduce swelling in the airways over time. Using your reliever more often than usual is a sign that your asthma is not well controlled and you should book a review.

Using an inhaler and spacer [kb:asthma:4]

Good technique gets the medicine into the lungs. A spacer makes most inhalers easier to use and is recommended for children. Ask a nurse or pharmacist to check your technique at each review, and rinse your mouth after using a preventer inhaler.

Asthma action plan [kb:asthma:5]

Everyone with asthma should have a written asthma action plan from their clinician that says what to do every day, when symptoms get worse, and in an emergency. An asthma attack where the reliever does not help, the person cannot speak in full sentences, or the lips turn blue is an emergency.

Clinic Hours and Contact

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Opening hours [kb:clinic_hours:1]

Greenfield Community Clinic is open Saturday to Thursday from 8:00 am to 8:00 pm. The clinic is closed on Fridays. The clinic pharmacy keeps the same hours, and the laboratory takes blood samples from 8:00 am to 12:00 noon.

Contacting the clinic [kb:clinic_hours:2]

Call the front desk number printed on your clinic card, or visit reception in person. The front desk can book appointments, answer questions about clinic services and put you through to the nurse triage line. Please do not send medical details or photos by social media messages.

Public holidays and after hours [kb:clinic_hours:3]

On public holidays the clinic opens from 9:00 am to 1:00 pm for urgent same-day appointments only. When the clinic is closed, go to the nearest hospital emergency department for urgent problems, or call 999 in an emergency.

Common Cold

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What a cold is [kb:common_cold:1]

A common cold is a viral infection of the nose and throat. Typical symptoms are a runny or blocked nose, sneezing, a mild sore throat, a cough and sometimes a low fever. Most colds get better on their own within 7 to 10 days, although a cough can last longer. Antibiotics do not work against cold viruses.

Home care for a cold [kb:common_cold:2]

Rest, drink plenty of fluids and eat what you can. Warm drinks, honey in warm water (not for babies under one year) and saline nose drops can ease symptoms. Wash your hands often and cover coughs and sneezes to protect others. If you use a cold remedy from a pharmacy, read the label and check that you are not taking the same active ingredient twice.

When to see a clinician about a cold [kb:common_cold:3]

Book an appointment if symptoms last longer than 10 days, if you feel better and then get worse again, if you have ear pain, or if you have a long-term condition such as asthma, diabetes or heart disease and your symptoms are getting worse. Get urgent help for difficulty breathing.

Minor Cuts and Scrapes

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Stopping minor bleeding [kb:cuts_scrapes:1]

Wash your hands, then press firmly on the cut with a clean cloth or bandage for several minutes. Raise the injured part above the level of the heart if you can. Most small cuts stop bleeding within about 10 minutes of steady pressure.

Cleaning a minor cut [kb:cuts_scrapes:2]

Rinse the cut under clean running water and gently remove dirt. Cover it with a clean dressing or plaster and change it daily or when it gets wet or dirty. Keeping the wound clean and covered helps it heal.

Signs a cut is infected [kb:cuts_scrapes:3]

Watch for redness that spreads, swelling, warmth, increasing pain, pus or a fever. These can be signs of infection and need to be checked by a clinician.

Tetanus protection after a cut [kb:cuts_scrapes:4]

Tetanus is a serious infection that can enter through a wound, especially one made by a dirty or rusty object, or an animal bite. If you are not sure your tetanus vaccination is up to date, contact the clinic after the injury.

When a cut needs stitches or medical care [kb:cuts_scrapes:5]

A cut may need medical care if it is deep or gaping, longer than about 2 cm, on the face, caused by an animal or human bite, has something stuck in it, or keeps bleeding after 10 minutes of firm pressure.

Dehydration and Oral Rehydration

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Signs of dehydration [kb:dehydration:1]

Dehydration means the body has lost more water and salts than it has taken in, often from diarrhoea, vomiting, fever or heat. Early signs are thirst, a dry mouth, dark yellow urine, passing urine less often, tiredness and dizziness when standing up. Babies may have fewer wet nappies and cry without tears.

Oral rehydration solution (ORS) [kb:dehydration:2]

Oral rehydration solution, or ORS, replaces both water and salts and is the first treatment for mild to moderate dehydration, especially from diarrhoea. Give small, frequent sips rather than large amounts at once. Keep breastfeeding babies and keep offering normal food once the person can eat.

Preparing ORS safely [kb:dehydration:3]

Mix an ORS packet with exactly the amount of clean, safe drinking water written on the packet. Too little water makes the solution too salty. Do not add sugar, juice or milk to ORS. Use the mixed solution within the time stated on the packet, usually 24 hours, and throw away what is left.

Danger signs of dehydration [kb:dehydration:4]

Get urgent medical care if a person is very drowsy or confused, cannot keep any fluids down, has not passed urine for 8 hours or more, has sunken eyes, or has blood in the stool. Babies and older adults become dangerously dehydrated faster, so seek care early for them.

Dengue

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What dengue is [kb:dengue:1]

Dengue is a viral infection spread by the bite of infected Aedes mosquitoes, which mostly bite during the day. Cases rise during and after the rainy season. Most people recover within one to two weeks, but some develop severe dengue, which needs hospital care.

Symptoms of dengue [kb:dengue:2]

Dengue usually starts with a high fever, severe headache, pain behind the eyes, muscle and joint pain, nausea and sometimes a rash. Anyone with these symptoms during dengue season should contact the clinic for advice and possible testing.

Care at home for dengue [kb:dengue:3]

Rest and drink plenty of fluids such as water and oral rehydration solution. Paracetamol is commonly used for fever and pain in dengue; follow the label or your clinician's advice. Avoid ibuprofen and aspirin unless a clinician tells you otherwise, because they can increase the risk of bleeding.

Dengue warning signs [kb:dengue:4]

The danger period is often around the time the fever goes down. Seek emergency care for severe stomach pain, repeated vomiting, bleeding from the gums or nose, blood in vomit or stool, fast breathing, extreme tiredness or restlessness, or cold, clammy skin.

Preventing mosquito bites [kb:dengue:5]

Remove standing water around the home at least once a week, cover water containers, use mosquito nets and screens, wear long sleeves and use an insect repellent as directed on the label. Protecting a person who has dengue from bites helps stop it spreading to others.

Diarrhoea

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Common causes of diarrhoea [kb:diarrhoea:1]

Sudden diarrhoea is usually caused by a viral infection or by contaminated food or water. It normally settles within a few days. The main risk is dehydration, not the diarrhoea itself.

Fluids and food during diarrhoea [kb:diarrhoea:2]

Drink more fluids than usual, and use oral rehydration solution (ORS) to replace lost salts. Keep eating small, regular meals of normal food. Children should continue breastfeeding or their usual milk. A clinician may advise zinc supplements for young children with diarrhoea.

Stopping diarrhoea from spreading [kb:diarrhoea:3]

Wash hands with soap after using the toilet, after changing nappies and before preparing food. Drink safe water, eat food that is freshly cooked and hot, and keep toilets clean. Do not prepare food for others while you have diarrhoea.

When to seek care for diarrhoea [kb:diarrhoea:4]

Contact the clinic if diarrhoea lasts more than 3 days in an adult or more than 1 day in a young child, or if there is a high fever or severe stomach pain. Seek urgent care for blood in the stool, signs of dehydration, or a baby who is not feeding.

Emergency Warning Signs

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When to call 999 [kb:emergency_signs:1]

Call 999, the national emergency number in Bangladesh, or go to the nearest emergency department straight away for any of the warning signs on this page. Do not wait for a clinic appointment and do not use telehealth or this assistant for an emergency.

Chest pain and heart attack signs [kb:emergency_signs:2]

Chest pain, pressure or tightness that lasts more than a few minutes, or spreads to the arm, neck, jaw or back, can be a heart attack. Other signs include shortness of breath, sweating, nausea and feeling faint. Call 999 straight away.

Stroke signs: think FAST [kb:emergency_signs:3]

FAST helps you spot a stroke. Face: is one side drooping? Arms: can the person lift both arms and keep them there? Speech: is it slurred or strange? Time: call 999 immediately. Every minute matters, even if the signs go away.

Breathing difficulty [kb:emergency_signs:4]

Severe difficulty breathing, gasping, being unable to speak in full sentences, or blue or grey lips are emergencies in adults and children. In children, also watch for the skin pulling in between the ribs with each breath.

Severe bleeding [kb:emergency_signs:5]

For heavy bleeding, press firmly on the wound with a clean cloth and keep pressing while someone calls 999. Bleeding that soaks through dressings, spurts, or does not slow down with firm pressure is an emergency, as is vomiting or coughing up blood.

Severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) [kb:emergency_signs:6]

Swelling of the lips, tongue or throat, difficulty breathing or swallowing, or collapse after a food, sting or medicine is an emergency. Call 999 and use an adrenaline auto-injector if the person has one.

Unconsciousness and seizures [kb:emergency_signs:7]

Call 999 if someone cannot be woken, has collapsed, or has a seizure that lasts more than five minutes, is their first seizure, or happens with an injury. Place an unconscious person who is breathing on their side.

Fever in young babies [kb:emergency_signs:8]

A temperature of 38.0 °C or higher in a baby younger than 3 months needs urgent medical assessment, even if the baby seems well. Also seek urgent care for any baby or child who is floppy, very hard to wake, or has a rash that does not fade when pressed.

Fever

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What counts as a fever [kb:fever:1]

A fever is a body temperature of 38.0 °C (100.4 °F) or higher. Fever is the body's normal response to an infection and is not an illness by itself. How a person looks and behaves often tells you more than the exact number on the thermometer.

Measuring a temperature [kb:fever:2]

A digital thermometer is the most reliable choice at home. Use it in the mouth or under the arm for adults and older children, and under the arm for babies and young children. Follow the instructions that come with your thermometer. Touching the forehead is not an accurate way to measure a fever.

Home care for a mild fever [kb:fever:3]

Rest, drink plenty of fluids and wear light clothing. Do not wrap a person with a fever in heavy blankets. A fever-reducing medicine from a pharmacy can be used for comfort; follow the label for age and amount, and ask a pharmacist if you are unsure. The goal is comfort, not a normal number on the thermometer.

Fever in babies and young children [kb:fever:4]

Any fever in a baby younger than 3 months needs to be checked by a clinician straight away, even if the baby seems well. Older babies and children should be seen if they are unusually sleepy, are not drinking, have a rash that does not fade when pressed, or the fever lasts more than 3 days.

When to seek care for a fever [kb:fever:5]

Contact the clinic if a fever lasts more than 3 days, keeps coming back, or comes with a severe headache, stiff neck, rash, pain when passing urine, or confusion. Go to emergency care for a fever with difficulty breathing, a seizure, or a person who is very hard to wake.

Preventing Infections

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When to wash your hands [kb:handwashing:1]

Wash your hands before preparing or eating food, after using the toilet or changing a nappy, after coughing, sneezing or blowing your nose, after touching animals or rubbish, and before and after caring for someone who is sick.

How to wash your hands [kb:handwashing:2]

Wet your hands with clean water, apply soap and rub all surfaces, including the backs of the hands, between the fingers and under the nails, for at least 20 seconds. Rinse and dry with a clean towel. Use an alcohol-based hand rub when soap and water are not available.

Covering coughs and wearing masks [kb:handwashing:3]

Cover coughs and sneezes with a tissue or the inside of your elbow, throw tissues away and wash your hands. If you have a cough or fever and must be around other people, a well-fitting mask helps protect them. Please wear a mask in the clinic waiting room if you have a cough.

Headaches

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Common types of headache [kb:headache:1]

The most common headache is a tension-type headache, which feels like a band of pressure around the head. Other common causes are colds, dehydration, missed meals, poor sleep, eye strain and stress. Migraines are less common, often one-sided and may come with nausea or sensitivity to light.

Self-care for headaches [kb:headache:2]

Drink water, eat regular meals, rest in a quiet, dark room, take breaks from screens and try to keep a regular sleep pattern. A pharmacy pain reliever can help occasionally; follow the label.

Medication-overuse headache [kb:headache:3]

Taking pain relievers for headaches on many days each month can itself cause more frequent headaches. If you need pain relief for headaches often, book an appointment instead of increasing your use.

Headache warning signs [kb:headache:4]

Get emergency care for a sudden, very severe headache, often described as the worst ever, or a headache with a stiff neck, fever and rash, confusion, weakness, trouble speaking, or after a head injury. Book an appointment for headaches that are new and keep getting worse.

Healthy Lifestyle

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Physical activity [kb:healthy_lifestyle:1]

Adults are generally advised to aim for at least 150 minutes of moderate activity a week, such as brisk walking or cycling, spread over most days, plus muscle-strengthening activity on two days. Any activity is better than none. Start slowly and ask a clinician first if you have a heart condition or other long-term illness.

Healthy eating [kb:healthy_lifestyle:2]

Eat plenty of vegetables, fruit, pulses and whole grains, choose fish, lean meat or beans for protein, and limit salt, sugar, sugary drinks and fried foods. Smaller portions of rice and more vegetables on the plate help with weight and blood sugar.

Tobacco and betel quid [kb:healthy_lifestyle:3]

Smoking and chewing tobacco or betel quid (paan with tobacco) cause cancer, heart disease and lung disease. Stopping at any age brings health benefits. The clinic offers support to help you quit; ask at your next appointment.

Sleep [kb:healthy_lifestyle:4]

Most adults need about 7 to 9 hours of sleep a night. A regular bedtime, a dark and quiet room, and avoiding screens and caffeine late in the day help. Talk to a clinician if you snore loudly and feel very sleepy during the day.

Heat Illness

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Heat exhaustion [kb:heat_illness:1]

Heat exhaustion can happen during very hot weather or hard work in the heat. Signs include heavy sweating, tiredness, headache, dizziness, nausea, muscle cramps and a fast pulse. Children, older adults and outdoor workers are at higher risk.

Cooling down [kb:heat_illness:2]

Move to a cool or shaded place, loosen clothing, lie down and raise the legs slightly, sip water or oral rehydration solution, and cool the skin with water and a fan. Symptoms usually improve within 30 minutes.

Heatstroke is an emergency [kb:heat_illness:3]

Heatstroke is life-threatening. Call 999 if someone is still unwell after 30 minutes of cooling, or has a very high body temperature, hot skin that has stopped sweating, confusion, a seizure or loss of consciousness. Keep cooling them while you wait for help.

Preventing heat illness [kb:heat_illness:4]

During hot weather, drink water regularly, avoid hard work or exercise in the hottest part of the day, wear light, loose clothing, rest in the shade and check on older neighbours and young children. Never leave a child or pet in a parked vehicle.

High Blood Pressure (Hypertension)

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What blood pressure numbers mean [kb:hypertension:1]

Blood pressure is written as two numbers, for example 120/80 mmHg. The top number is the pressure when the heart beats, and the bottom number is the pressure between beats. High blood pressure usually has no symptoms, which is why regular checks matter. Your clinician decides what your target should be.

Why high blood pressure matters [kb:hypertension:2]

Over many years, high blood pressure damages blood vessels. It raises the risk of stroke, heart attack, heart failure, kidney disease and eye problems. Keeping blood pressure under control lowers these risks.

Lifestyle steps for healthy blood pressure [kb:hypertension:3]

Eat less salt and fewer salty snacks, eat more vegetables and fruit, stay active most days, keep a healthy weight, limit alcohol and stop smoking. Good sleep and managing stress also help. These steps support any medicine your clinician prescribes.

Checking blood pressure at home [kb:hypertension:4]

If your clinician asks you to check at home, sit quietly for five minutes first, keep your arm supported at heart level, and do not talk during the reading. Use a validated upper-arm monitor and write down the results with the date and time to bring to your appointment.

Blood pressure medicines [kb:hypertension:5]

Take blood pressure medicines exactly as prescribed, even when you feel well. Do not stop or change them on your own. If you think a medicine is causing side effects, or you have missed doses, speak to your clinician or pharmacist.

Influenza (Flu)

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Flu compared with a cold [kb:influenza:1]

Flu is caused by influenza viruses. It usually starts suddenly with fever, muscle aches, tiredness, headache and a dry cough. A cold usually starts slowly and is milder. Most healthy people recover from flu in about one to two weeks, but tiredness can last longer.

Home care and stopping the spread of flu [kb:influenza:2]

Rest at home, drink plenty of fluids and stay away from others until you have had no fever for at least 24 hours without fever-reducing medicine. Cover coughs and sneezes with a tissue or your elbow and wash your hands often. Do not go to work or school while you have a fever.

People at higher risk from flu [kb:influenza:3]

Flu can be more serious for adults over 65, pregnant women, young children, and people with long-term conditions such as asthma, diabetes, heart disease or a weak immune system. People in these groups should contact the clinic early when flu symptoms start, because a clinician may want to assess them. A yearly flu vaccine is the best protection.

Flu warning signs [kb:influenza:4]

Seek care quickly for difficulty breathing, chest pain, confusion, severe weakness, a fever that comes back after improving, or signs of dehydration such as passing very little urine. In children, also watch for fast breathing, bluish lips and not drinking.

Blood Tests and Results

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Preparing for a blood test [kb:lab_tests:1]

Some blood tests, such as a fasting glucose or cholesterol test, need you to stop eating for a set time beforehand. Follow the exact instructions you were given when the test was booked. Unless told otherwise, keep drinking water and take your usual medicines.

Getting your test results [kb:lab_tests:2]

Most routine results are ready within 3 working days. A clinician reviews every result first. The clinic will contact you if anything needs action; otherwise you can view results in the patient portal or ask at your next appointment.

Understanding your results [kb:lab_tests:3]

Test results need to be read together with your symptoms, history and other results, so only a clinician can explain what your results mean for you. Book an appointment or a telehealth visit to go through them.

Storing and Disposing of Medicines

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Storing medicines [kb:medicine_storage:1]

Store medicines in a cool, dry place away from direct sunlight, in their original packaging with the label. A bathroom is usually too damp. Some medicines, such as insulin or certain liquids, need a refrigerator; the label or pharmacist will tell you.

Keeping children safe from medicines [kb:medicine_storage:2]

Keep all medicines, including vitamins and iron tablets, up high and out of sight and reach of children, ideally in a locked box. Close child-resistant caps properly after each use and never call medicine sweets.

Disposing of unused or expired medicines [kb:medicine_storage:3]

Do not use medicines after their expiry date. Bring unused or expired medicines to the clinic pharmacy for safe disposal. Do not throw them in household rubbish or flush them down the toilet unless the label says to.

Keeping a medicine list [kb:medicine_storage:4]

Keep an up-to-date list of every medicine you take, including OTC products, vitamins and herbal remedies, with the strength and how often you take it. Bring the list to every appointment and show it to the pharmacist when you buy something new.

Mental Health and Wellbeing

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Stress, low mood and anxiety [kb:mental_health:1]

Everyone feels stressed, low or worried at times. When these feelings last more than two weeks, or make it hard to sleep, work, study or look after yourself, it is a good time to talk to someone. Mental health problems are common and treatable.

Looking after your wellbeing [kb:mental_health:2]

Regular sleep, physical activity, time outdoors, eating regular meals and staying in touch with people you trust all support mental wellbeing. Try to limit alcohol and avoid using other substances to cope.

Counselling at the clinic [kb:mental_health:3]

Greenfield Community Clinic offers confidential counselling appointments with a trained counsellor. You can ask for one at the front desk or during any appointment. You do not need a referral, and what you share is kept private within your care team.

In a mental health crisis [kb:mental_health:4]

If you or someone else is thinking about suicide or self-harm, or is in immediate danger, call 999 now or go to the nearest emergency department. Stay with the person if it is safe, and remove anything they could use to hurt themselves.

Minor Burns

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First aid for a minor burn [kb:minor_burns:1]

Cool the burn under cool or lukewarm running water for 20 minutes as soon as possible. Remove rings, watches and tight clothing near the burn before it swells, unless they are stuck to the skin. Keep the person warm while cooling the burn.

What not to put on a burn [kb:minor_burns:2]

Do not use ice, iced water, butter, oil, toothpaste or other home remedies on a burn. They can damage the skin further or cause infection. Do not burst blisters.

Covering a minor burn [kb:minor_burns:3]

After cooling, cover the burn loosely with cling film or a clean, non-fluffy dressing to protect it. A pharmacy pain reliever can be used for comfort; follow the label. Keep the area clean while it heals.

When a burn needs medical care [kb:minor_burns:4]

See a clinician for burns larger than the person's palm, burns on the face, hands, feet, joints or genitals, deep burns that look white or charred, burns from chemicals or electricity, and any burn in a young child or older adult. Signs of infection, such as increasing redness, pus or fever, also need a check.

Over-the-Counter Medicines

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What over-the-counter means [kb:otc_medicines:1]

Over-the-counter (OTC) medicines can be bought without a prescription, for example some pain relievers, antihistamines and antacids. OTC does not mean risk-free: they can still cause side effects, interact with other medicines or be unsafe for some people.

Reading a medicine label [kb:otc_medicines:2]

Before taking any medicine, read the whole label. Check the active ingredient, what it is for, who should not take it, how much to take, how often, and the maximum amount in 24 hours. Keep the leaflet in case you need to check it again.

Avoiding a double dose of the same ingredient [kb:otc_medicines:3]

Many cold and flu remedies contain the same active ingredient as a pain reliever, often paracetamol. Taking two products with the same ingredient can lead to an accidental overdose. Compare the active ingredients on every product you take, and ask a pharmacist if you are not sure.

Medicines for children [kb:otc_medicines:4]

Use only products made for children, follow the age and weight guidance on the label, and measure liquid medicines with the syringe or spoon that comes with them, not a kitchen spoon. Some adult medicines, such as aspirin, are not suitable for children. Ask a pharmacist before giving any new medicine.

When to ask before using OTC medicines [kb:otc_medicines:5]

Speak to a pharmacist or clinician before using any OTC medicine if you are pregnant or breastfeeding, take regular prescription medicines, have a long-term condition such as kidney, liver or heart disease, or are buying for a baby. Only a clinician who knows your history can advise on doses for you personally.

Prescriptions and Refills

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Repeat prescriptions [kb:prescriptions:1]

If you take a regular medicine, request a repeat prescription at least 5 working days before you run out, at the front desk, through the patient portal or during a telehealth visit. Some medicines need a review appointment before they can be repeated.

Lost prescriptions or medicines [kb:prescriptions:2]

If you lose a prescription or your medicines, contact the front desk. A clinician will decide whether a replacement can be issued; for some medicines a new appointment is needed.

Questions about your medicine [kb:prescriptions:3]

For questions about how to take a medicine, side effects or whether two medicines can be taken together, ask the clinic pharmacist or your clinician. They can check your record and other medicines, which this handbook cannot do.

Medical Records and Privacy

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What the clinic keeps in your record [kb:records_privacy:1]

Your medical record includes your contact details, visit notes, test results, prescriptions, vaccinations and letters. It is stored securely and used only for your care and for running the clinic safely.

Who can see your record [kb:records_privacy:2]

Only the clinicians and staff involved in your care can open your record, and every access is logged. The clinic does not share your record with family members, employers or anyone else without your written consent, except where the law requires it.

Requesting a copy of your records [kb:records_privacy:3]

To get a copy of your medical records, fill in a records request form at the front desk and show a photo ID. Copies are usually ready within 7 working days. A parent or legal guardian can request records for a child.

Your medical record number [kb:records_privacy:4]

Every patient has a medical record number (MRN) that starts with GCC followed by six digits. Keep it private, like a password. Clinic staff will never ask for your MRN by social media or text message.

About the clinic assistant [kb:records_privacy:5]

The clinic assistant answers general questions from this handbook only. It cannot see your medical record, cannot book appointments and does not keep your questions after answering. Please do not type your name, phone number, ID numbers or record number into it.

Sore Throat

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.

Common causes of a sore throat [kb:sore_throat:1]

Most sore throats are caused by viruses, often with a cold, and get better within about a week without antibiotics. A smaller number are caused by bacteria, such as strep throat, which a clinician can test for.

Home care for a sore throat [kb:sore_throat:2]

Drink plenty of fluids, rest, and try warm drinks or cold foods to soothe the throat. Adults can gargle with warm salty water. Throat lozenges can help older children and adults but are a choking risk for young children.

When to see a clinician about a sore throat [kb:sore_throat:3]

Book an appointment if the sore throat lasts more than a week, if you have a high fever, white patches on the tonsils with swollen neck glands, or if it is very painful to swallow. Get emergency help if you cannot swallow your saliva, are drooling, or have difficulty breathing.

Telehealth Visits

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.

What telehealth is good for [kb:telehealth:1]

Telehealth visits are video or phone appointments with a clinician. They work well for follow-ups, reviewing test results, repeat prescriptions, mental health check-ins and simple problems that do not need a physical examination. Telehealth runs Sunday to Thursday from 9:00 am to 5:00 pm.

When telehealth is not suitable [kb:telehealth:2]

Telehealth is not for emergencies. Chest pain, difficulty breathing, severe bleeding, stroke signs or a very unwell child need emergency care, so call 999. Problems that need an examination or a test may need an in-person visit.

Preparing for a telehealth visit [kb:telehealth:3]

Book a telehealth slot through the front desk or the patient portal. Before the call, charge your phone or computer, find a quiet room with good light and internet, and have your medicine list and any home readings ready.

Privacy during a telehealth visit [kb:telehealth:4]

Join from a private place where others cannot overhear. The clinic uses an encrypted video service and does not record visits. Do not join from a shared computer you do not trust, and log out when the visit ends.

Type 2 Diabetes

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.

What type 2 diabetes is [kb:type2_diabetes:1]

In type 2 diabetes the body does not use insulin well, so the level of sugar (glucose) in the blood stays too high. It develops slowly and is more likely with older age, a family history, being overweight and low physical activity. It is diagnosed with blood tests ordered by a clinician.

Common symptoms of diabetes [kb:type2_diabetes:2]

Many people have no symptoms at first. Possible symptoms include feeling very thirsty, passing urine often, tiredness, blurred vision, slow-healing cuts and frequent infections. Anyone with these symptoms should book a check-up.

Living with type 2 diabetes [kb:type2_diabetes:3]

Management usually combines healthy eating, regular physical activity, weight management, not smoking, and medicines when needed. Some people are asked to check their blood sugar at home; your care team will tell you if and when to test.

Low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia) [kb:type2_diabetes:4]

Some diabetes medicines can make blood sugar drop too low. Signs include shaking, sweating, sudden hunger, a fast heartbeat, confusion and irritability. People at risk should follow the low-sugar plan agreed with their care team. Someone who becomes drowsy, confused or unconscious needs emergency help.

Foot and eye care with diabetes [kb:type2_diabetes:5]

Diabetes can reduce feeling in the feet and damage the eyes. Check your feet every day for cuts, blisters or colour changes, wear comfortable shoes, and never walk barefoot outdoors. Have an eye check and a foot check at least once a year.

Regular diabetes check-ups [kb:type2_diabetes:6]

Regular reviews usually include an HbA1c blood test, which shows average blood sugar over about three months, as well as blood pressure, cholesterol and kidney tests. Bring your medicine list and any home readings to each review.

Vaccination Schedule Overview

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.

Why vaccines matter [kb:vaccinations:1]

Vaccines train the immune system to protect against serious infections such as measles, polio, tetanus, diphtheria, whooping cough and some types of pneumonia. Vaccinating on time protects your child and helps protect babies and people who cannot be vaccinated.

Childhood vaccines overview [kb:vaccinations:2]

Children in Bangladesh are vaccinated through the national Expanded Programme on Immunization (EPI). In general, BCG and a first polio dose are given around birth, a series of combination vaccine doses starts at about 6 weeks of age with further doses a few weeks apart, and measles-rubella vaccine is given later in the first year with a second dose after that. Your child's vaccination card shows the exact schedule.

Missed or late vaccine doses [kb:vaccinations:3]

If your child missed a vaccine, they can usually catch up; there is no need to start the whole series again. Bring the vaccination card to the clinic and a nurse will check which doses are due.

Vaccines for adults [kb:vaccinations:4]

Adults may need a tetanus booster, a yearly flu vaccine (especially older adults, pregnant women and people with long-term conditions), and other vaccines depending on age, health, work or travel. Ask at your next appointment which vaccines are right for you.

After a vaccination [kb:vaccinations:5]

Mild reactions are common and usually pass within one to two days: soreness or redness where the needle went in, a mild fever, or being irritable. Contact the clinic for a high fever or a reaction that lasts longer. Swelling of the face or difficulty breathing soon after a vaccine is an emergency.

Choosing the Right Care

Educational, fictional clinic handbook; not medical advice.

Self-care at home [kb:when_to_seek_care:1]

Many minor illnesses, such as colds, mild sore throats, small cuts and minor burns, can be looked after at home with rest, fluids and advice from a pharmacist. Watch for warning signs and seek care if symptoms get worse or do not improve.

Same-day appointment [kb:when_to_seek_care:2]

Ask for a same-day appointment for problems that are not emergencies but should not wait, for example a fever that lasts more than 3 days, ear pain, pain when passing urine, a wound that looks infected, or a long-term condition that is getting worse.

Emergency care [kb:when_to_seek_care:3]

Emergencies include chest pain, difficulty breathing, stroke signs, severe bleeding, a severe allergic reaction, unconsciousness, a seizure and fever in a baby under 3 months. For these, call 999 or go to the nearest emergency department.

If you are not sure where to go [kb:when_to_seek_care:4]

If you are unsure how urgent a problem is, call the clinic front desk during opening hours and ask for the nurse triage line. Outside opening hours, if you think it might be an emergency, treat it as one and call 999.